



Volkswagen unveils Sedric

Sedric is Volkswagen's first fully autonomous vehicle with a 'Level 5' autonomy- No steering wheel, no pedals. <http://dgit.in/SedricCar>



More Smartwatches!

Movado, Tommy Hilfiger and Hugo Boss to launch Android Wear 2.0 watches this fall. <http://dgit.in/MTHsmart>

Digit Squad



Jen Fitzpatrick, Head of Google Maps, addressing the Local Guides. View the talk here <http://dgit.in/JFLGS2016>

Journey to San Francisco

On 12th September, all of the 75 local guides including 25 Googlers stayed at Hyatt, San Francisco. At the same day in evening we had a welcome reception at our hotel and it was really awesome to meet other 74 local guides. We shared some souvenirs among us.

Inside Googleplex

Next day (13th morning) we had some private meetings with top officials from Google. There, the 75 guides were divided into 7 teams, and I got place in Team Yellow. The Vice president of Google maps, Jen Fitzpatrick (she was the first female engineer in Google) gave a welcome speech to us, and she mentioned the top 5 Local Guides who helped improvement of Google Maps to a large extent. In that top 5, apart from me, there was a Malaysian girl who uploaded 640 GB of photos to the map, and another boy who showcased the physically disabled people on his videos. A man from Nigeria also featured in that list who helped in the Google Local Business. Jen had an engaging talk about the Local Guides group and the great stuff the community is doing. "Our ultimate aspiration is to build the richest, deepest, most detailed understanding of the real world that's ever existed and to share that back to our users," Jen told us. "You are the community that's helping us build that understanding."

Google Street View

After the panel, we got to hear from one of the creators of Street View, who made it what it is today. Daniel Filip started at Google in 2007 and was originally tasked with creating 360 "photospheres" for the Street View project. He described how one can easily capture a 360 degree photo without the help of 360 cam using Street View app from Play Store/App Store. And they can interconnect pictures taken at the same location. Similarly a person can upload spherical photos via Google desktop pano editor and connected photos for proper navigation. So that people can see a 360 degree photo of a business. To view a part of the talk in 360, go to <http://dgit.in/DFLGS2016>.

Lunch time fun at Googleplex

In the afternoon we had a series of breakout sessions led by product managers and engineers on topics such as Google My Business and saving places to lists. We ended a very busy day with a BBQ on campus with food, games and mingling.

Google San Francisco office

On 14th we visited the Google San Francisco office and met other Google employees there. These meetings involved learning from Local Guides community managers and getting some tips from star meet-up hosts. Then we walked some of streets in Mission District, San Francisco. We visited some local stores and made necessary corrections in Google Maps. The closing party was held at Mission Bowling club.

Conclusion

I would suggest others to join Local Guides programme and do it as something fun. Mapping the world is very useful. If you are already involved in the program, then their couldn't be a better time to up your game since Google has announced the Local Guides Summit for 2017. The criteria is pretty much the same and applications are open between 3rd to 24th April. The good news is that this year, 150 applicants will be shortlisted for the summit from around the world. The chances couldn't be any better, so what are you waiting for? 🇮🇳



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